

Figure 3: KeepNote

saved on a per-folder basis, so you can sort a journal folder on date, and a notes folder on title, all in the same notebook.

If all this were not enough, you can even write extensions. There are two available on the KeepNote website: one that lets you import NoteCase notebooks (yes, the outliner we discussed previously) and another which even lets you import a hierarchy of folders as a notebook. The latter is bound to be a gift to all you systematic types, who already keep well-organised folders. Installing a new extension is as simple as downloading it and using the 'Preferences' page to install it. The notebook structure is also amenable to direct browsing, should the need arise, and you can also edit the pages and inserted images with your favourite applications. But there's more...

Exporting to HTML does justice to the notebook format. The exported notebook offers a split-pane view, with the tree nodes listed in the left pane respectively hyperlinked to pages that open in the right pane. This ensures that you have the same ease of navigation with an exported notebook as you have with the outliner proper.

KeepNote does not allow you to name a page with a date stamp, though it gives you a lot of options to format the date stamp. You have to insert the date stamp, available via the menu, into a page—and then use it to rename a node, unless I have missed something in the documentation. But I can already see you sweeping this aside, given the many features stacked in favour of KeepNote.

ZimWiki

ZimWiki claims to be a desktop wiki, and does a great job of it. It is very good for taking notes on the fly, because it has first-class support for wiki syntax. For instance, if you have enabled 'CameCaps', then typing 'TomsIdeas' will create this word as a hyperlink. The target page for this link comes into existence when you click the hyperlink and enter some content. Similarly, you can make text **bold**, *italicised*, or underscored, and these are just some of the many formatting actions you can do with the wiki syntax. Referring to the Help section is the best way to view and understand ZimWiki features. Remember to enable **View>Index** to see the tree view in the left pane.

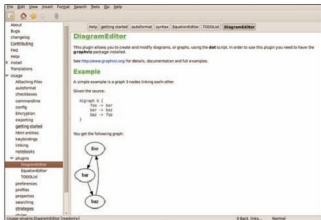


Figure 4: ZimWiki

ZimWiki can be a great notebook, and also an aid to decent documentation in rushed or 'live' situations such as meetings or lectures, especially if you are a touch-typist. The one thing that ZimWiki can lay strong claim to is being a journal with action item tracking. To start a journal, bring up the calendar widget (**View>Calendar**), and click on a date. The tree pane on the left automatically creates a hierarchical structure with year, month, and date. Start typing into the date node to make that page permanent. This allows you to have a 'sparse' journal, where you have pages only for those days when you have something to write about. Action or 'To-Do' items can be entered on any page within their specific context. You can manage them centrally via the **View>TODO List** menu item, which consolidates all 'To-Do' items across the notebook into a single view.

A quirk I could not get around was that items in the index or tree view sort themselves in alphabetical order, whether you want it or not. I would prefer that the nodes stayed in the order in which I inserted them, with an option to sort them at will.

A final note

This has by no means been an exhaustive list, and I am sure you will find more applications in this category. With FOSS software, your favourite application is yet to come. Meanwhile, enjoy taking down those notes with these tools—at least until the novelty wears off! **END** 

References

<http://digitaldump.wordpress.com/projects/rednotebook/> The RedNoteBook website.
<http://notecase.sourceforge.net/> The NoteCase site.
<http://rasm.ods.org/keepnote/> The KeepNote site.
<http://www.pardus.nl/projects/zim> The ZimWiki site.

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